

WRITING SUB-TEST – MEDICINE

Notes

Assume that today's date is 08/01/2024

You are Dr Sarah Mitchell, an ENT Specialist

Patient Details

- **Name:** Mr Adam Wilson
- **Date of Birth:** 15/03/1982 (42 years old)

Patient History

- Social drinker
- Non-smoker

Family History

- Father: Myocardial infarction
- Mother: Type 2 diabetes mellitus

Medical History

- Type 2 diabetes mellitus × 5 years
- Hypertension

Medications: - Metformin / Norvasc

07/2023

Left upper molar root canal treatment

08/01/2024

- C/O left facial pain × 3 months
- Persistent unilateral nasal discharge (L)
- Foul nasal smell
- Post-nasal drip
- Pain worse on bending forward
- No fever
- No epistaxis
- No visual disturbance
- Recurrent dental infection
- Multiple courses oral antibiotics → minimal improvement

Examination

- Facial tenderness over the left maxillary sinus
- Purulent discharge observed in the left middle meatus during nasal endoscopy
- Tenderness over the left upper molar region
- Temperature: 36.8°C; Pulse: 78 bpm; Blood Pressure: 125/85 mmHg

Investigations

- **CT PNS:** Opacification of the left maxillary sinus. Evidence of periapical dental infection communicating with the sinus.

Diagnosis

- Odontogenic maxillary sinusitis

Management

- Diagnosis explained to patient
- Advised nasal saline irrigation
- Analgesia recommended
- Treatment of dental source indicated

Plan

- Refer to family dentist for definitive dental management ± dental surgery
- Consider combined ENT–dental intervention if symptoms persist

Writing Task

“Using the information given in the case notes, write a letter of referral to Dr James Carter. Address the letter to Dr James Carter, Family Dentist, Riverside Dental Practice, 45 High Street, London.”